legislative devolution resulted in the grant of almost complete internal autonomy to the provinces in 1937.

3. It also provided for the establishment of new legislative councils for Bengal, North-western Provinces and Punjab, which were established in 1862, 1886 and 1897, respectively.

4. It empowered the Viceroy to make rules and orders for the more convenient transaction of business in the council. It also gave a recognition to the 'portfolio' system, introduced by Lord Canning in 1859. Under this, a member of the viceroy's council was made in-charge of one or more departments of the Government and was authorised to issue final orders on behalf of the council on matters of his department(s).

5. It empowered the Viceroy to issue ordinances, without the concurrence of the legislative council, during an emergency. The life of such an ordinance was six months.

 **Indian Councils Act of 1892**

The features of this Act were as follows:

1. It increased the number of additional (non-official) members in the Central and provincial legislative councils, but maintained the official majority in them.

2. It increased the functions of legislative councils and gave them the power of discussing the budget[5] and addressing questions to the executive.

3. It provided for the nomination of some non-official members of the (a) Central Legislative Council by the Viceroy on the recommendation of the provincial legislative councils and the Bengal Chamber of Commerce, and (b) that of the provincial legislative councils by the Governors on the recommendation of the district boards, municipalities, universities, trade associations, zamindars and chambers.

"The act made a limited and indirect provision for the use of election in filling up some of the non-official seats both in the Central and provincial legislative councils. The word **election** was, however, not used in the Act. The process was described as nomination made on the recommendation of certain bodies"[6].

 **Indian Councils Act of 1909**

This Act is also known as Morley-Minto Reforms (Lord Morley was the then Secretary of State for India and Lord Minto was the then viceroy of India).

The features of this Act were as follows:

1. It considerably increased the size of the legislative councils, both Central and Provincial. The number of members in the Central legislative council was raised from 16 to 60. The number of members in the provincial legislative councils was not uniform.

2. It retained official majority in the Central legislative council, but allowed the provincial legislative councils to have non-official majority.